



ALEONPRESS

BONUS GUIDE 3 OF 4

# The Interview Preparation Guide

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What to do before, during, and after the interview — including a simple framework for answering almost any behavioral question.

## 01

## Before the Interview

### RESEARCH (30–45 MINUTES)

- The company: what they do, recent news, mission/values page
- The role: re-read the posting and note every requirement you can speak to directly
- Your interviewer, if you know their name: their role and background on LinkedIn

### LOGISTICS

- Confirm the format (phone, video, in person) and log in or arrive 10 minutes early
- For video calls: test your camera, mic, and lighting the day before
- Print or have your resume open — interviewers often reference it directly

**TIP**

Prepare 3–4 specific stories from your work history before you walk in. You will reuse them across multiple questions — this is the highest-leverage prep you can do.

## 02

## The STAR Method

Most behavioral questions ("Tell me about a time when...") are best answered with the STAR structure — it keeps your answer concrete instead of vague.

- **Situation** — briefly set the scene
- **Task** — what you were responsible for
- **Action** — what you specifically did (not what the team did)
- **Result** — the outcome, with a number if you have one

**EXAMPLE**

*"Our department was seeing a 30% no-show rate for appointments (Situation). I was asked to find a fix (Task). I proposed and built an automated reminder system with a 48-hour and 2-hour text alert (Action). No-shows dropped to 12% within two months (Result)."*

## 03

## Common Questions to Prepare For

- "Tell me about yourself" — a 60–90 second walkthrough of your background, ending at why you want this role
- "Why do you want to work here?" — reference something specific from your research, not generic praise
- "What's a challenge you've faced at work?" — use STAR, and pick something you actually resolved

- "Where do you see yourself in 5 years?" — show ambition that's realistic and aligned with this role
- "Do you have any questions for us?" — always say yes (see below)

## 04

# Questions to Ask Them

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Asking good questions signals genuine interest and helps you evaluate the role right back. Have 3–4 ready:

- "What does success look like in this role in the first 90 days?"
- "What's the biggest challenge facing the team right now?"
- "How would you describe the team's working style?"
- "What made you decide to join this company?" (great for the interviewer personally)

## 05

# After the Interview

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Send a thank-you email within 24 hours — short, specific, and genuine.

### EXAMPLE

*Subject: Thank you — [Role Title] Hi [Name], thank you for taking the time to speak with me today about the [Role Title] position. I especially enjoyed hearing about [specific detail from the conversation] — it reinforced how excited I am about the opportunity. Please let me know if there's anything else I can provide. Looking forward to hearing from you. Best, [Your Name]*

If you haven't heard back within the timeline they gave you, one polite follow-up is appropriate — after that, let it go and keep applying elsewhere.